```
square = (x) ->
  x * x
```

Now you have CoffeeScript. Think of it as JavaScript after a little bit of spring cleaning (see figure 1.2). Most Ruby or Python developers will immediately find this new syntax comfortable and familiar, whereas most C, C++, or Java programmers will immediately find it alien. But the familiarity of the syntax isn't important. What *is* important is how the new syntax fits how people think about the programs written using it. Why? Because a more natural syntax can not only make your life as a programmer easier; it can also help you start to think differently about your programs by letting you concentrate on other things—like the problems you're trying to solve with the language. In that way, learning CoffeeScript can help you learn new ways of programming.

Figure 1.2. Agtron and Scruffy doing some spring cleaning of the JavaScript syntax

